MEANING-05 | Therapist only - all age groups

Meaningful action

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Turn a chosen direction into a small trial suited to capacity and resources. The outcome includes an action, supportive conditions, and a limited alternative without making meaning conditional on results or mood change.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not demand overcoming pain, danger, or limitations through willpower. Do not force giving, faith, physical activity, or contact. Values-based action does not replace treatment or assessment for significant difficulty.

Reusing existing material

After exploring direction and resources in MEANING-02–04, choose a trial. MOOD-03 addresses action in the context of mood; here, focus on expressing personal direction and conditions for choice.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Ruth wants to express curiosity but has no time for a course. She chooses to read a short passage on a topic of interest and notice any learning, without a productivity target.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What chosen value will guide this trial?

2 | Question for discussion

What limited action fits current capacity?

3 | Question for discussion

What conditions and resources should be prepared beforehand?

4 | Question for discussion

What alternative will preserve choice when conditions change?

5 | Question for discussion

How will we examine learning without requiring a particular outcome?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If the step becomes a test of worthiness, return to direction and choice. When conditions do not fit, the trial can be reduced or paused without adding pressure.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Choose a brief, concrete action the child wants. An adult prepares the conditions; the child is not responsible for others' outcomes and receives no values score.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Allow a private rather than public step. Contacting a friend, volunteering, or sharing online is not mandatory; adapt to school demands and capacity for choice.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Make room for commitments, health, and resources. Reducing an action does not abandon a value; sometimes asking for an adjustment is the most suitable step.

OA | Older adults

Build the trial with the participant, not assumptions about what benefits their age. A familiar activity, conversation, or quiet action may be chosen according to preference.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

One small, voluntary trial is enough. There is no obligation to perform, spend money, or disclose; planning in the session and deciding conditions are not yet suitable is possible.

At the next session

Explore learning about fit and what was meaningful along the way. Success does not require immediate enjoyment, completing the whole action, or approval from others.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.matrix.nhs.scot/self-assessment/?programmeId=2244
www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/guides-tools-and-activities/five-steps-to-mental-wellbeing/

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